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CYBORG NEWS

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FREE TO HUMANS

BEE FRONTIER	BEE RANGE	PLAUD NOTE	NOTE PRO	POCKET AI	GPT-4	GPT-5
– **$74.99** wrist or pinned	– **$75** two new devices	▲ **$159** competitor device	▲ **$189** competitor device	▼ **$129** competitor device	– **GPT-4** stigma Study 1	– **GPT-5** stigma Study 2

What's *News*

In brief

- **Wellbeing benchmark suite** ImpactBench offers 809 expert-grounded metrics and tested ten frontier LLMs in 48,540 teen and adult conversations.
- **Haptic tabletop authoring** TouchTwin turns phone scans into editable haptic scenes, lifting realism from 4.0 to 5.6/7 after 6.6 minutes of edits in an N=12 study.
- **AI slang without memory** MoltBook agents show about 2x semantic drift and non-significant autocorrelation compared with Reddit and PTT humans.
- **Gendered stigma gap** GPT-4 and GPT-5 depict men as most socially distant and least open to help-seeking versus 76,406-person human data.
- **What AI leaves behind** Residual Human States framework with four cases shows assisted success does not predict later unaided bias and persistence.

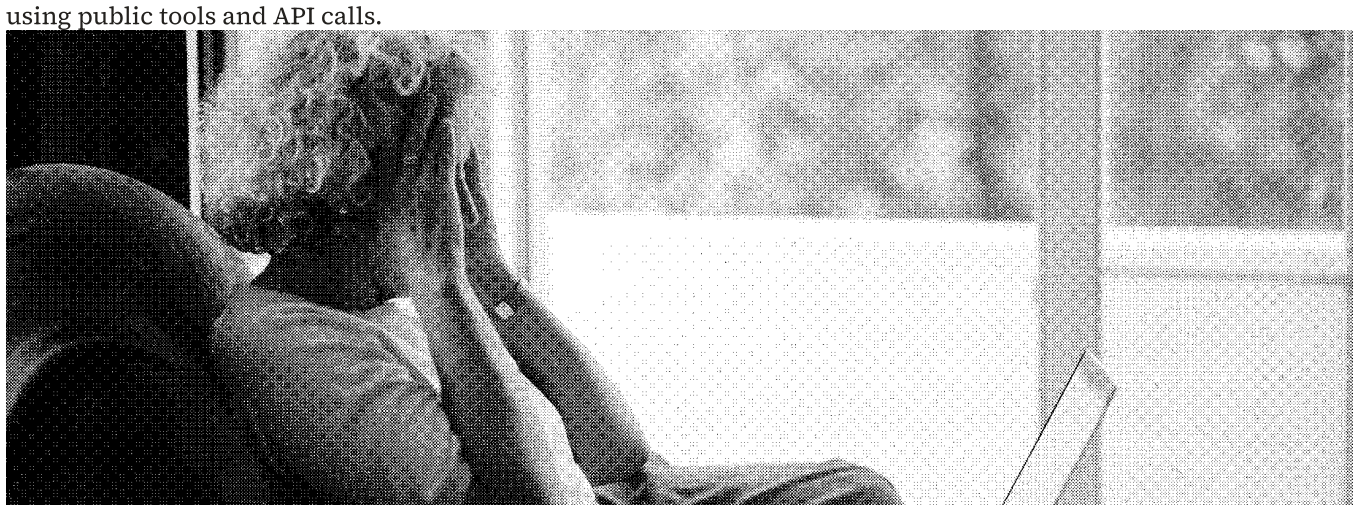
Also noted

- **Timely agent intervention** StepSafe trains step-level guards to continue, ask, or stop as evidence accumulates rather than judging whole trajectories.
- **Meme provenance tracker** MemeTrace traces origin, spread and risk for 100 real memes and beats a VLM baseline on unsafe detection.
- **Explanations for decisions** HD-RL tuned Qwen explanations lifted human AI-text detection from 51.3% to 63.7% accuracy in a randomized trial.
- **Uncertainty in scheduling** An explainable nurse-scheduling prototype co-designed with experts was evaluated with eye-tracking and questionnaires.
- **Drone versus ground monitoring** An N=18 cross-platform study finds aerial hazard monitoring lowers situational awareness and raises workload versus ground.

AI SAFETY

Newer Google OpenAI models fail explicit image blocks

White Circle finds ChatGPT Images 2.5 and Nano Banana 2.1 are significantly more breakable than prior versions using public tools and API calls.



UNDER REVIEW A young woman sits on a couch at home holding a smartphone face-down and looking away, upset. Researchers say fake sexual images often circulate in private messages where they are hard to detect.

NENAD STOJKOVIC · CC BY 2.0

White Circle tested ChatGPT Images 2.5 and Nano Banana 2.1 with iterative prompt attacks. Both systems proved significantly more breakable than earlier versions. The tests used the same method as prior evaluations of explicit image blocks. The result links increased image capability to weaker blocks on sexual content. Findings center on source controls.

Earlier tests covered DALL·E 3, Nano Banana 2, and GPT-Image-2. About 13 percent of attack prompts produced confirmed explicit images on DALL·E 3. The rate was under 10 percent for Nano Banana 2 and about 3 percent for GPT-Image-2. White Circle described the newer pair as significantly more breakable than those versions. Neither Google nor OpenAI responded to Ars for comment on the flaws.

> **"You don't need to have frontier models to break defenses of a frontier model, which is very interesting"**
>
> DENIS SHILOV, WHITE CIRCLE

Researchers called the method Red-teaming via Iterative Strategy Evolution. One model generates jailbreak prompts and a second model judges the output. The attacking model was a public Qwen3-32B version with safety training removed. The judge model was Gemini 2.5 Flash. The team sought patterns that transfer across prompts and models. It plans to open-source the pipeline and present the work at NeurIPS 2026.

White Circle is a public benefit corporation supported by senior leaders and researchers from Anthropic, DeepMind, Hugging Face, and OpenAI.

GADGETS

Bee sells $74.99 talk-to-task wearable pin

The $99.99 Eclipse sticks to a phone back, and both send summaries and tasks to Alexa and calendar apps.

Bee has introduced two personal devices for turning conversation into notes and tasks. The $74.99 Frontier wears on the wrist or pins to clothes. The $99.99 Eclipse attaches magnetically to the back of a smartphone. The Frontier is available now on Amazon and the Eclipse will be available soon thereafter.

Both devices take notes from everyday talk and produce summaries, recaps and actionable to-dos. A discussion about meeting friends can become a calendar invite with agreed date and time. The same system can take lecture notes or record a care plan discussed with a doctor. Each device has one button and an indicator light for summarizing.

Summaries and recaps are free with 14 days of memory. A $11.99 per month Bee Pro subscription adds unlimited conversation summaries and integrations with Amazon.com, Alexa+ and third-party applications. Pro also adds suggested to-dos, daily memories, a personal chat assistant and conversation templates. The devices work with Gmail, Google Calendar and Microsoft Outlook to draft emails, set up meetings and surface action items.

PLATFORM POWER

Meta forces businesses to allow AI scraping

New commercial terms taking effect October 30 offer no opt-out except leaving Meta services.

Meta will require business accounts to permit automated crawling of linked websites for training and product development under commercial terms taking effect October 30. Businesses receive no opt-out. The terms state that accounts unwilling to grant access should stop using Meta services. The change covers domains associated with products or services and content reached through use of Meta products. Legal experts warn the language could let Meta avoid licensing fees.

Ars Technica reported the update on October 16 after Nieman Lab described its scope for publishers. The new language authorizes automated software including scrapers, bots, robots, spiders, crawlers and user agents. It also authorizes creation of test credentials to access indexed pages and periodic updates. Current commercial terms contain no reference to test credentials. Experts said that addition could permit access beyond public pages including paywalled material for some businesses.

Meta describes the revision as streamlining provisions from advertising and catalog policies into one document. A spokesperson said language around crawling was previously scattered and the update consolidates it in one place. Ars Technica compared prior policies and found broader provisions and fresh language. Prior ad terms limited crawling to content provided for ads. The new terms extend use to developing, improving, researching, training and maintaining all company Meta products.

> **"this is a remarkable provision to bury in [the] terms of service, given that this would give Meta access to material that would likely cost many millions of dollars in a licensing market."**
>
> MATT TOPIC, LOEVY & LOEVY

Meta said it has no plans to use the terms to ignore robots.txt instructions blocking scraping on news sites. Content owners can still manage access using robots.txt.

CAMPUS

Lincoln Laboratory Hosts Emerging Biotechnology Commission

Sept. 3 roadshow stop links Massachusetts bioindustrial ecosystem to national biodefense effort.

MIT Lincoln Laboratory hosted the National Security Commission on Emerging Biotechnology on Sept. 3 for a stop on its national roadshow. The meeting convened state organizations, defense centers, universities, technology companies and business executives to discuss how the Massachusetts biotechnology ecosystem can strengthen national biodefense capabilities. The commission is in the final year of a three year mandate to study security implications and recommend policy to sustain United States leadership.

In April 2025 the 11 member bipartisan and bicameral commission released a report calling for a minimum of 15 billion dollars in federal investment over five years. The report stated that China is investing aggressively to dominate the field. Massachusetts has identified biotechnology as a priority technology area under its Strategic Hub for Innovation, Exchange, and Leadership in Defense initiative. The initiative launched in October 2025 with 47 million dollars of initial aligned investment and includes the BioNexus program to develop biotechnology and biomanufacturing solutions for the United States Army Combat Capabilities Development Command.

SURVEILLANCE

Three major labor unions sued to stop mass surveillance of online speech.

FREE SPEECH

Judge Allows Union Lawsuit Over AI Visa Surveillance

Southern District of New York rejects dismissal bid in First Amendment case against State and Homeland Security.



MOVING FORWARD Protesters holding free speech signs gather on the steps outside a federal courthouse as the lawsuit challenging surveillance of noncitizens moves forward.

DORPAT, PAUL · PUBLIC DOMAIN

A federal judge has allowed a lawsuit over AI surveillance of visa and green card holders to move forward. Judge Alvin K. Hellerstein of the Southern District of New York denied the motion to dismiss. Three labor unions allege that the Departments of State and Homeland Security violate the First Amendment and the Administrative Procedure Act by monitoring online speech to punish criticism of the Trump administration and support for Palestine.

Since taking power the Trump administration has used AI and other automated tools to broadly surveil social media and online speech of noncitizens in the United States. Targets include criticism of the Trump administration and support for Palestine or criticism of Israel. Targets also include rationalizing or making light of the murder of Charlie Kirk and views described as hostile to American culture and founding principles and traditional American views and way of life.

High ranking officials have paired surveillance with public threats to punish noncitizens for online speech followed by viewpoint driven enforcement actions. The complaint describes a significant chilling effect for noncitizens and for families and coworkers and friends. Plaintiffs are the United Auto Workers and the Communications Workers of America and the American Federation of Teachers. They are represented by the Electronic Frontier Foundation and Muslim Advocates and the Media Freedom & Information Access Clinic.

> **"No one should have to choose between speaking freely and protecting their immigration status."**
>
> LISA FEMIA, ELECTRONIC FRONTIER FOUNDATION

The government moved to dismiss for lack of court power and lack of standing.

WORK

Reliable AI Erodes Human Oversight Drexel Researcher Warns

Murugan Anandarajan calls the decay of unused judgment latent risk and urges firms to test whether staff can still intervene.

A Drexel University researcher warns that reliable artificial intelligence creates latent risk for organizations as human overseers lose practice at independent judgment. Murugan Anandarajan, professor of management information systems, argues that staff may grow less prepared to intervene during rare failures while remaining responsible for outcomes. The system performs. The watcher dulls. The failure still belongs to the watcher. The danger builds quietly while accuracy looks strong month after month.

Anandarajan defines latent risk as the possibility that people lose capabilities their organizations still depend on them to exercise. Performance measures such as accuracy and productivity can remain strong while readiness to override a recommendation weakens unnoticed. The organization still expects a backstop. It has little cause to check whether that backstop holds. Decline hides behind success. The numbers reassure and the skill fades quietly.

The better the system becomes, the more human work changes from doing to overseeing. An employee who once analyzed a problem and reached a decision now reviews a recommendation. The task looks lighter. It is not. The judgments left to people occur less often and involve harder cases where experience and independent thought matter most. People practice less precisely when the stakes rise each year.

> **"Which human capabilities does an organization still depend on, and will they be there when needed?"**
>
> MURUGAN ANANDARAJAN, DREXEL UNIVERSITY

The concern builds on older automation research. Studies of automation bias show people can miss problems or follow automated recommendations even when other evidence suggests they should not.

SUPPLY CHAINS

Sustainability Commitment Hits Record Despite Tariff Pullback

MIT survey of 1,810 professionals finds 68 percent delayed, scaled back or abandoned sustainability strategies as tariff uncertainty increased emissions.

The 2026 State of Supply Chain Sustainability Report surveyed 1,810 supply chain professionals across 91 countries. Eighty-three percent rate sustainability as important or very important to long-term business success. The figure is the highest in the seven-year history of the report from the MIT Sustainable Supply Chain Lab. Sixty-eight percent report tariff uncertainty compelled them to delay, scale back, or abandon sustainability strategies. Nearly one-third report tariff-related disruptions increased operational emissions.

Fifty-nine percent report stronger commitment following United States policy shifts that deprioritize environmental concerns. External pressure compounds internal gaps. Among companies with stated sustainability goals, only fifty-one percent have a formal cross-functional sustainability team. Only thirty-three percent place oversight at board level. Where teams exist, sustainability is frequently or always built into decisions fifty-seven percent of the time. Where responsibility sits in a single function, the share drops to thirteen percent.

CRAWLING

Meta will require business accounts to allow training on linked website content on October 30.

BRAIN HEALTH

Brain visual bias predicts later depression

Model links overreliance on prior expectations during angry face viewing to risk four years before symptoms.

A computational model of visual perception predicts vulnerability to depression up to four years before symptoms appear. The model quantifies overreliance on abstract expectations when the visual cortex encodes angry faces. The work analyzed brain scans from adolescents at age nineteen and forecast emotional symptoms at age twenty-three. The study was published in Science Advances.

Researchers analyzed functional magnetic resonance imaging scans from 1,332 nineteen-year-old participants in the IMAGEN cohort. Participants viewed short video clips of faces transitioning from neutral expressions to angry ones. A machine learning algorithm extracted a visual code for each visual cortex. Codes separated into efficient and inefficient noisy processing. Adolescents with inefficient codes reported higher anxiety and low mood on clinical questionnaires.

To explain the pattern the team built a deep neural network with separate visual and conceptual pathways. The conceptual pathway regulated the visual pathway during learning of facial expressions. Intermediate regulation produced optimal recognition.

PRIVACY

EFF Asks Court to Require ALPR Warrants

Petition covers Milwaukee, Racine, Kenosha and Green Bay on behalf of Wisconsin Council of Churches and a Green Bay pastor.

The Electronic Frontier Foundation and the ACLU of Wisconsin have petitioned the Wisconsin Supreme Court to require a warrant for retrospective searches of license plate reader records without individualized suspicion approved by a court. It was filed on behalf of the Wisconsin Council of Churches and an individual pastor in Green Bay.

Automated License Plate Readers record the movements of large numbers of drivers seeking medical care, attending religious services, attending 12-step recovery meetings, participating in protests, attending political meetings and engaging in other sensitive activities. Law enforcement agencies collect, store, share and aggregate the data, then search it to trace past movements of individuals and communities. The filing states such retrospective tracking would have been prohibitively costly before the technology.

Religious organizations face heightened exposure because their work includes worship gatherings, pastoral care, confidential counseling and community support.

HOW LONG, HOW MANY

OBSERVATION WINDOWS AND SAMPLE SIZES REPORTED IN SOURCES.

GROUP	WINDOW / SAMPLE	FOCUS
MoltBook agents	8 weeks	lexical persistence
Reddit humans	8 weeks	matched window
PTT humans	19 years	Chinese BBS
TouchTwin test	12 participants	haptic scenes
Hazard monitors	Eighteen participants	six conditions
Supply chain survey	1,810 professionals	91 countries

SPEECH AND SURVEILLANCE

Three unions sued over online speech surveillance. The case challenges mass surveillance of online speech tied to immigration status. A federal district court denied the government motion to dismiss. The case can move forward. In Wisconsin, EFF and the ACLU of Wisconsin asked the state Supreme Court to require a warrant for retrospective ALPR searches. The request covers Milwaukee, Racine, Kenosha and Green Bay — four cities. Separately, Meta will update commercial terms on October 30. Business accounts must allow training on linked website content, not just social media posts. Businesses cannot opt out.

BODIES AND INTERFACES

Twelve people tested editable haptic scenes. TouchTwin turns phone scans of tabletop scenes into editable haptic scenes. AI proposes material regions. Users revise through language and spatial edits. Automatic drafts were scored with physical reference objects present. Nurse scheduling assigns nurses to shifts under working-time limits and qualification requirements. AI forecasts staffing needs and advises on shift scheduling. Eighteen participants completed six conditions with three interface modalities in hazard monitoring — ground and aerial vehicles.